



▲ TIBETAN MEDA

Date c.1780

Origin Tibet

Weight 4.15kg (9lb)

Barrel 1.11m (3¾ft)

Calibre 17mm

Tibet was largely isolated from the rest of the world but carried out trade with India and China. This *meda* (matchlock) shows Chinese influence in form and decoration. Attached to the fore stock is an unusual rest, while the ramrod is a modern replacement.

Rest terminates in forked antelope horn



▲ TURKISH SNAPHAUNCE

Date Late 18th century

Origin Turkey

Weight 2.69kg (6lb)

Barrel 72.4cm (28½in)

The smoothbore Turkish *tüfek*, or musket, combines a pentagonal-section butt with an octagonal barrel. Its lock is a snaphaunce, a predecessor of the flintlock, which had become obsolete in northern Europe by the early 1600s.



▲ DOUBLE-BARRELLED FLINTLOCK WITH BAYONET

Date c.1800

Origin England

The blunderbuss-type muzzle of this double-barrelled weapon features a folding spike bayonet. Naval crews appreciated guns that combined short-range firepower with a stabbing weapon.

Folding spike bayonet



▲ ENGLISH FLINTLOCK RIFLE

Date 1791

Origin England

Weight 3.5kg (7¾lb)

Barrel 81cm (32in)

Calibre .680in

Innovative London gunsmith Henry Nock made several volley guns for the Royal Navy and numbered Ezekiel Baker among his apprentices. Nock designed this flintlock weapon – possibly an officer's private purchase – with nine-groove rifling.

Grooved barrel

Fore sight

Ramrod



▲ MATCHLOCK REVOLVING MUSKET

Date c.1800

Origin India

Weight 5.9kg (13lb)

Barrel 62cm (24½in)

Calibre .6in

An unusual matchlock revolving musket from Indore, this gun uses a mechanical sophistication sometimes seen in European flintlocks – the use of a revolving cylinder to create a multi-shot weapon. The cylinder is indexed manually.

Chamber vent

Revolving cylinder with six chambers

Ramrod



Discharger cup



Sling swivel

Pentagonal-section butt

Decorated iron lock plate

▼ INDORE TORADAR

Date c.1800

Origin India

Weight 3.4kg (7½lb)

Barrel 1.12m (3¾ft)

Calibre .55in

This simple matchlock from Indore, central India, has a pronounced recurve. Four leather thongs serve as barrel bands, although the one closest to the breech is made of wire.

Wire barrel band

Leather barrel band

